

Council Meeting
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The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Tuesday, April 23, 2019, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Assistant Mayor Damren at 6:30 p.m.

Members of the Council present were:

At-Large Councilor Claire Lessard
Ward I Councilor Andrew O’Hearne
Ward III Councilor Jonathan Stone
Assistant Mayor Allen Damren
At-Large Councilor Jeremy Zullo
At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski
Ward II Councilor Scott Pope

Members of the Council absent were:

Mayor Charlene Lovett
At-Large Councilor Abigail Kier

CITIZEN’S FORUM

None

OLD BUSINESS

Selection of Community Members and City Department Leaders for City Manager Search Committee

Mr. Damren stated that 13 applications have been received from interested citizens that would like to join the search process. They are:

Debora Matteau
Kristen Kenniston
Philip “Joe” Osgood
Carolyn Towle
Raymond Gagnon
James Contois
David Pacetti
Marlene Boisclair

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Brian Rapp
Mark Limoges
Colby Casey
Lloyd Smrkovski
Chad Rolston

Our task, per the city council vote, is to choose 4 people. The committee is a total of 9 people and will be comprised of 3 councilors, 2 department heads and 4 community members.

Mr. Damren said the community survey has been online for a couple of weeks and we have received 120 responses as of today. The survey has 8 questions. Of the responses received to date the top 3 characteristics being looked for in the new city manager is someone with experience with:

Community development or redevelopment
Budget, finance and forecasting
Represent community positively

These match up well with the candidate profile that was done a couple of years ago, but we will go through the process to see if it needs to be updated at all.

Mr. Damren said the best way to start would be to have everyone stated their top 4 choices and hopefully there will be a couple of people that will be name by everyone and we can go from there.

Mr. Pope: Colby Casey, Kristin Kenniston, Carolyn Towle, Raymond Gagnon
Mr. Koloski: Debora Matteau, Kristin Kenniston, Colby Casey, Lloyd Smrkovski
Mr. Zullo: Lloyd Smrkovski, Mark Limoges, Colby Casey, Philip Osgood
Mr. Stone: Philip Osgood, Mark Limoges, Lloyd Smrkovski, Marlene Boisclair
Mr. O'Hearne: Raymond Gagnon, Chad Rolston, Mark Limoges, Philip Osgood
Ms. Lessard: Debora Matteau, Philip Osgood, Marlene Boisclair, Mark Limoges
Mr. Damren – Kristin Kenniston, Raymond Gagnon, Colby Casey, Lloyd Smrkovski

Being that there was not a name picked by everyone, each councilor spoke about why they choose the 4 they did. A discussion followed.

A motion was made by Mr. O'Hearne and seconded by Mr. Stone to nominate Raymond Gagnon to the City Manager Search Committee.

Roll Call vote:
Lessard - yes
O'Hearne - yes
Stone – yes
Damren -yes

Zullo - yes
Koloski - yes
Pope - yes
Motion carried 7-0

A motion was made by Mr. Pope and seconded by Mr. Zullo to nominate Mark Limoges, Lloyd Smrkovski and Philip “Joe” Osgood to the City Manager Search Committee.

Mr. O’Hearne stated he feels they should do all individual votes.

The census was they are ok with the blanket vote.

Roll Call vote:
Lessard - yes
O’Hearne - no
Stone – yes
Damren -yes
Zullo - yes
Koloski - no
Pope - yes
Motion carried 5-2

Mr. Damren said he will call the individuals to inform them of the vote.

Mr. Koloski said there is one change he would like to see in the ad which currently states that it’s a city form of government with 7 councilors, an assistant mayor & mayor. The first part steers it to that we are a strong mayor city. He would like to see it say City Manager and 9-member City Council.

Mr. Damren stated he had a change as well; he would like to see the part about consistency and long tenure of 15 years removed.

Mr. Damren will work on these changes for the ad and get it to the council.

It was discussed that the council needs come up with a contract that includes pay range and benefits before someone is hired.

Mr. Damren stated that Acting City Manager MacLean canvassed his department heads to see who would be available to serve on the search committee. The 2 Claremont residents he came up with were Police Chief Mark Chase and Park & Recreation Director Mark Brislin.

A motion was made by Mr. Koloski and seconded by Mr. O’Hearne to nominate Mark Chase and Mark Brislin to the City Manager Search Committee.

Roll Call vote:

Lessard - yes

O’Hearne - yes

Stone – yes

Damren -yes

Zullo - yes

Koloski - yes

Pope - yes

Motion carried 7-0

FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS AND DIRECTIVES

None

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

None

ADJOURNMENT

At 7:08 p.m., a motion was made by Mr. O’Hearne and seconded by Mr. Zullo to adjourn.

Voice vote: motion carried 7-0

Respectfully Submitted,

Gwendolyn R. Melcher

City Clerk